INSTITUTIONAL & ENTERPRISE FAQS

Institutional & Enterprise FAQs

Operational and compliance framework for institutional review of the Inaya Protocol.

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SECTION Q1

How is Inaya architecturally different from legacy decentralized storage?

Legacy decentralized storage protocols (Filecoin, Arweave) focus on commodity file hosting, where complete files often reside intact on a single node. Inaya operates as a zero-knowledge custody orchestration layer: files never leave the enterprise user's device in a unified state. Client-side encryption and binary sharding happen before anything reaches the network — the blockchain is used purely as an immutable metadata attestation log, never as file storage itself.

SECTION Q2

What is the current storage pricing model?

Pay-As-You-Go storage is billed in USDT at the rate set on the deployed contracts. Storage does not require a separate $INAYA fee — $INAYA's utility centers on staking, governance, and retrieval beyond the included monthly allowance, not the upload itself.

FEE	CURRENT RATE	BASIS
Storage (USDT)	6.49 USDT / TB / month	Set on the deployed PAYG contract; about 7% under the lowest competitor list price (Backblaze B2, 6.95) as of November 2026
Upload, one-time (USDT)	0.0063 USDT / GB (6.49 USDT / TB)	One month of storage; set on the deployed InayaCustody contract
Account fee (USDT)	12 USDT / year	Flat annual maintenance fee on the PAYG contract
Storage ingress ($INAYA)	0 — not charged	$INAYA plays no role in ingress pricing today
Retrieval up to stored volume	Included every month	No charge for retrieving up to the amount stored each month
Retrieval beyond that ($INAYA)	10 $INAYA / 0.5 TB, not yet active	Activates at mainnet, by design — not a testnet gap

SECTION Q3

What are the enterprise storage tier options?

The real, implemented structure is the Corporate Reserve annual plan — a fixed data allocation billed once a year in USDT, with maintenance settled in $INAYA-equivalent value.

ALLOCATION	RESERVE FEE (USDT/YR)	PER TB PER MONTH	ANNUAL MAINTENANCE
250 TB / Year	17,970	5.99 USDT	500 USDT-eq.
500 TB / Year	34,740	5.79 USDT	1,000 USDT-eq.
1000 TB / Year	65,880	5.49 USDT	2,000 USDT-eq.

SECTION Q4

How does client-side binary sharding work, mathematically?

On file ingestion, the browser runtime derives a key via PBKDF2 (100,000 iterations, HMAC-SHA256, 16-byte random salt), encrypts with AES-GCM-256, then splits the resulting ciphertext at its exact midpoint byte into two shards.

```
Mp = floor(length(C) / 2)
Shard Alpha = C[0 ... Mp-1]
Shard Beta  = C[Mp ... end]
```

> Because neither shard contains a contiguous bit structure, an isolated compromise of any single storage node yields only random binary noise — external exfiltration from one node alone is not viable.

SECTION Q5

How does corporate revenue actually settle on-chain?

1. **1.** The customer approves USDT and calls RevenueRouter.processCorporateInvoice() — one on-chain transaction.
2. **2.** The client separately approves USDT and calls InayaCorporateEscrow.createEscrow() to escrow the node-operator's 35% share — a second, independent transaction.
3. **3.** The escrow releases that allocation over 12 fixed monthly payouts.

ALLOCATION	PURPOSE
35%	Node Reward Escrow — 12-month vesting to the operator who serviced the invoice
55%	Company Treasury
10%	Team & Platform Operations

How the split works. Payment and escrow are two separate transactions started from the customer's checkout. The 35% node-operator share is a fixed value in the production payment code, not an estimate. The remaining 65% splits 55% to the company treasury and 10% to team and platform operations, which matches the protocol's EBITDA math (65% gross margin − 3% grants − 5% R&D − 2% admin, legal and marketing = 55%).

SECTION Q6

What does the unit-economics / margin structure look like?

LINE ITEM	% OF GROSS NETWORK INFLOW
Gross Network Inflow (Total Sales)	100%
Node Operator Commissions (COGS)	35%
Protocol Net Retention (Gross Margin)	65%
Ecosystem Grants & Scholarships	3%
Tech R&D & Global Telemetry Scaling	5%
Admin, Legal & Marketing	2%
Target Protocol EBITDA Margin	55%

This reconciles exactly: 65% gross margin minus 3% grants, 5% R&D, and 2% admin/legal/marketing leaves 55% — the same 55% that appears as the Company Treasury's share of the RevenueRouter split in Q5, since Treasury is where that margin actually accrues before the smaller opex lines are drawn down against it.

SECTION Q7

Does Inaya offer anything beyond the storage protocol for enterprise buyers?

Yes — Business Workspace is a fully independent B2B SaaS product built on the same infrastructure: organizations, departments, projects, documents, server-enforced approval workflows, granular permissions, secure external sharing, and a permission-aware AI assistant. It's priced and evaluated like any other business software — an institutional buyer never has to engage with the token economics above to use it. As of September 2026, a Sovereign Enterprise OS layer also ties the whole workspace together: one home screen showing real trust & health status (built from the actual audit trail and backup data, not a decorative dashboard), unified notifications, cross-module search, and a single AI assistant covering both business and security questions. Also as of September 2026: a public Trust Center where an outside party can independently, cryptographically verify Inaya's own audit chain in their own browser (rather than take Inaya's word for it); a scoped API-key developer platform for programmatic access; cross-organization trust primitives; recovery capability that's automatically re-tested daily against real infrastructure using synthetic, system-owned assets — never a real customer's data; real Microsoft Entra ID/Active Directory identity integration with MSP multi-tenancy; and an AI Bookkeeper. As of October 2026: Sovereign Infrastructure — an institutional buyer can connect their own server and run real virtual machines, block storage, and private networking on it from the Business Workspace, with a working subset of AWS CLI compatibility, a real HAProxy load balancer, and real Kubernetes (k3s) — their own hardware, managed through the same console, not a separate product to learn.

SECTION Q8

What did the two October 2026 additions (Secure Collaboration; Device Protection) add, and what's still hedged?

Secure Collaboration (Filen/FileCloud-inspired) added end-to-end encrypted Secure Chat (the MLS group-messaging standard, RFC 9420) and Secure Notes, Sharing 2.0 (expiring/password-protected/watermarked links, inbound file requests), Governance (classification, DLP, retention, legal hold, a secure viewer), device trust/block/revoke, and a Sovereign Gateway agent connecting a customer's own on-premises file servers. Device Protection (Internxt-inspired) added a hybrid post-quantum key-establishment layer, a local-only desktop duplicate/junk-file scanner (Inaya Cleaner), and private peer-to-peer video calls (Inaya Meet) that reuse Secure Chat for in-call messaging. Every feature in both additions is off by default per organization.

CLAIM	WHAT'S ACTUALLY TRUE
Post-quantum	Hybrid key establishment — the existing classical X25519 exchange combined with ML-KEM-768 through a domain-separated HKDF. Additive to classical cryptography, not a replacement; file encryption itself (AES-256-GCM) is unchanged.
Chat security	Real MLS group messaging; the server stores and relays ciphertext only. The open-source MLS library used has not had an independent security audit.
Meet	Peer-to-peer/mesh video, not routed through an Inaya server, trading a scalable SFU for a stronger privacy property at a conservative default room size.
Cleaner	Local-only; never uploads a file inventory anywhere; moves deletions to the OS trash rather than deleting permanently.

A full, line-item verification ledger (what's VERIFIED against real tests and a real browser versus IMPLEMENTED_NOT_LIVE versus PARTIAL) is available on request for an institutional reviewer's own technical diligence.